

ExhibitGuide

A visitor-intelligence & lead-capture layer for independent commercial galleries. A prospect scans the QR beside a work with their own phone — no install — gets the story in audio, video or text, and hands the gallery a warm, contextualised lead.

Progressive Web App

QR scan — no app install

B2B — galleries pay

I. SCAN

A QR code beside any artwork opens the page instantly — no app, no install.

II. READ OR LISTEN

Artist statement, provenance and price-on-request — in text, audio or video.

III. CAPTURE

Every scan is an intent signal; an opt-in save becomes a warm CRM lead for the gallery.

LENA HARGREAVES

Tidemark IV, 2024

Oil & pigment on linen · 160 x 130 cm · Price on request



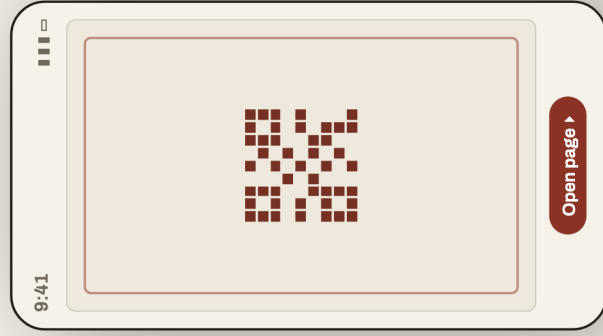
Scan for the story —
statement,
provenance, and a
price list.

We stopped selling museums an audio guide. We sell galleries a *lead engine*.

The original brief targeted museums on a B2B2C model. Two structural problems killed it — so we pivoted to the customer with real pain, real budget and a fast decision. **The wedge is the independent commercial gallery.**

1,500⁺ institutions already run Bloomberg Connects — and it is free, philanthropically funded. Why museums are unwinnable	6–18^{mo} museum procurement: director → board → curator → IT → purchasing. Runway-killing. Why museums are unwinnable	£0.5–10^M annual sales at a mid-tier gallery — a budget owned by sales, not a cost centre. Why galleries can buy	1 person the director is often the sole decision-maker. Weeks to close, not years. Why galleries decide fast
THE REFRAME THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE Real pain Lost sales at peak intent; statements and provenance trapped on printed sheets; staff stretched at openings.	Structural moat Bloomberg’s philanthropic mandate forbids charging for-profit dealers — it cannot follow us here.	The data flywheel Every scan is an intent event; opt-in turns it into a CRM lead. Engagement-to-sale history compounds into switching cost.	

From the artwork to a warm, captured lead in four taps.



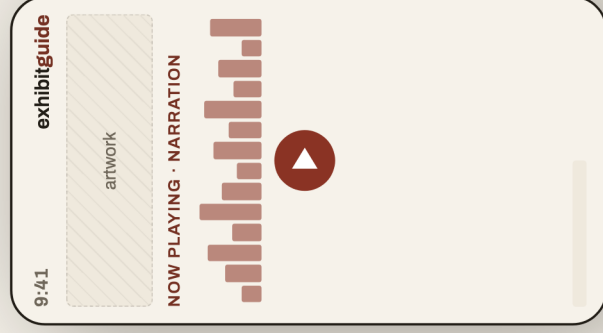
i. Scan

Camera reads the QR on the mount — no app, no install.



ii. Choose

Statement, provenance, price-on-request; listen, watch, read or save — no sign-in.



iii. Listen

Hands-free narration so eyes stay on the work, not the phone.



iv. Capture

Opt-in turns the save into a warm lead — with the gallery's first context attached.

What it *feels like* — and the lead it leaves behind.



Rachel, 41, a serious collector, is at a private view in Mayfair. She's drawn to one large canvas but the room is busy and she doesn't want to flag down a stretched sales assistant just to ask the basics.

18:40 · STANDS <i>In front of the work</i> She wants the artist's statement, the provenance and the price — before committing to a conversation.	18:41 · SCANS <i>Her own phone</i> The QR beside the work opens the page in a tap — no app, no sign-up, no queue for staff.	18:42 · READS <i>Statement & provenance</i> Full context and a price-on-request, at her own pace — and a quiet engagement event is logged.	18:45 · SAVES <i>Requests the price list</i> She opts in to a wishlist and a price list — handing the gallery a warm, contextualised lead.	NEXT DAY · FOLLOW-UP <i>The gallery calls with context</i> “You spent time with the Hargreaves on Thursday — two related works are available.”
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THE USP
No rental counter, no app store, no cold follow-up — the gallery now knows who looked at what, for how long, and can sell with context no content tool captures.

Two people matter: who *pays*, and who *scans*.

<i>The operator</i>	
GALLERY DIRECTOR • PAYS	
WHO	Director or sales lead of an independent commercial gallery; 1–5 staff, 6–12 shows a year, £0.5–10M sales.
PAIN	Loses sales at peak intent; statements live on printed sheets; no digital engagement layer in the space.
BEHAVIOUR	Owens a sales budget; active on Artsy & Instagram; decides in weeks, often alone.

<i>The prospector</i>	
COLLECTOR / SERIOUS VISITOR	
WHO	A serious visitor at an opening or viewing, on their own phone (iPhone Safari / Android Chrome).
WANT	The story and the price <i>before</i> committing to a sales conversation — at their own pace.
BEHAVIOUR	Scans, reads or listens, saves a piece, opts in for a price list and show alerts.

<i>The expansion</i>	
SAME MECHANISM, MORE SCALE	
ART FAIRS	Frieze, The Armory Show, NADA — the same scan → lead loop at 10× density.
LUXURY RETAIL	Furniture showrooms, jewellery, bespoke fashion — curated storytelling that converts.
THE CONSTANT	Scan → engagement event → CRM lead. The vertical changes; the wedge doesn't.

Why it's defensible	Bloomberg Connects is philanthropic and museum-only; Smartify is built for institutional procurement and has <i>no</i> lead-capture layer. The engagement-to-sale data compounds into a switching cost that has nothing to do with price.
THE POINT OF THE PIVOT	

A boring, proven stack — with one layer that is the *whole moat*.

<i>Frontend</i> React PWA + Tailwind Mobile-first, installable, service-worker cached — a polished UI for a luxury sales context.	<i>API</i> Django REST Framework One clean REST layer serving the visitor PWA and the gallery dashboard alike.	<i>Backend + CMS</i> Django + admin The admin <i>is</i> the v1 gallery CMS — staff add shows & artworks with zero custom build.	<i>Auth</i> dj-rest-auth + JWT Visitor save-account and gallery-staff login out of the box. SSO deferred.
<i>Database</i> PostgreSQL Artworks, accounts, wishlists, annotations — and the engagement events & leads.	<i>Media</i> S3-compatible + CDN Audio, video and high-res images served fast inside the gallery space.	<i>Intelligence</i> Engagement events Every scan / listen / watch / read logged as a location-and-intent signal.	<i>CRM · the moat</i> Native leads + export Opt-in saves become lead records with engagement context; CSV / webhook to the gallery's CRM.
DEFERRED BY DESIGN Held back until the core is validated: Celery + Redis async follow-up & rollups · deep CRM integrations (HubSpot / Artsy / Mailchimp) · Claude API AI summaries & translation · Wagtail · SSO.			

Agile in one-week sprints — version-controlled and demoable every week.

Development method AGILE — SCRUM FLAVOUR

Wireframes mapped to user stories; a prioritised feature backlog; a demoable increment presented every Thursday, with UAT in a real gallery from Sprint 2.

Version control GITHUB

Feature-branch workflow — each branch maps to a backlog item and sprint deliverable; pull-request review; main always deployable.

THE WEEKLY LOOP

i.

Plan

Pull the next user stories off the prioritised backlog into the sprint.

ii.

Build

One feature branch per story; PR review; tests run in CI before merge.

iii.

Demo

A working increment shown every Thursday for feedback and re-prioritising.

iv.

Validate

From Sprint 2, test the increment with real visitors in a real gallery.

DEFINITION OF DONE

Merged via PR review · automated tests green in CI · deployed to staging · and demoed against its user story's acceptance criteria.

Read free, capture the lead — the intelligence layer is in the MVP.

READ CORE

MVP

Scan to story
The validated core — built and piloted first, no login

■ QR scanning

— camera opens the artwork page directly

■ Artwork page

— statement, provenance, price-on-request

■ READ in 3 formats

— text, audio narration, video

■ PWA + offline

— cached for patchy gallery WiFi

■ Gallery CMS

— staff publish via the Django admin

WISHLIST

MVP · CRUD

Save, annotate, manage
Account gate appears only at the moment of saving

■ Accounts

— email register, login, logout, reset

■ Create

— save an artwork to a wishlist

■ Read

— re-open saved works after the visit

■ Update

— annotate pieces; rename a wishlist

■ Delete

— remove a work or a whole wishlist (GDPR)

INTELLIGENCE

MVP · THE MOAT

Capture the lead
Epic 7 — what Bloomberg & Smarify can't do

■ Engagement events

— every scan/listen/watch/read logged

■ Lead capture

— opt-in save / price-list request → warm lead

■ Gallery dashboard

— engagement by artwork + lead inbox

■ Context attached

— each lead carries its engagement history

■ CRM export

— CSV / webhook to the gallery's tools

OUT OF MVP SCOPE

Deliberately held back until the core proves itself: deep CRM integrations & automated follow-up · art fair & luxury retail modes · AI summaries · SSO · Celery async.

Eight epics in build order — the moat is *Epic 7*.

EPIC 1 · 2 MVP Content & READ ■ Gallery CMS — publish shows & artworks ■ QR deep-link to artwork page ■ Statement · provenance · price-on-request ■ Text · audio · video formats ■ NFC tap (Android) — enhancement	EPIC 3 · 4 MVP · CRUD Accounts & save ■ Email register, login / logout ■ Password reset · JWT session ■ Gate shown only at save ■ Create — save to a wishlist ■ Save-on-login completes the action	EPIC 5 · 6 · 8 MVP · CRUD Wishlist R-U-D ■ Read — revisit saved works post-visit ■ Update — annotate · rename ■ Delete — remove item / wishlist (GDPR) ■ Epic 8 — PWA offline caching	EPIC 7 THE MOAT Intelligence & leads ■ Capture engagement events ■ Opt-in lead capture ■ Gallery lead inbox + context ■ Engagement analytics by artwork ■ CRM export (CSV / webhook)
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Two roles — the *prospect* who scans and the *operator* who sells.

QR DEEP-LINK · NO ACCOUNT

As a prospect,

I WANT the artwork page to open straight from my camera,

SO THAT I get the story instantly without an app or sign-up.

READ · STATEMENT & PRICE

As a collector at a viewing,

I WANT the statement, provenance and price-on-request,

SO THAT I can judge a work before talking to staff.

WISHLIST · CREATE + UPDATE

As a logged-in prospect,

I WANT to save works and annotate them privately,

SO THAT I can weigh them up before deciding.

LEAD CAPTURE · OPT-IN

As a prospect,

I WANT to request a price list and share my contact,

SO THAT the gallery follows up with relevant works.

LEAD INBOX · WITH CONTEXT

As a gallery operator,

I WANT a lead list showing what each prospect engaged with,

SO THAT my sales follow-up is informed, not cold.

GALLERY CMS

As a gallery operator,

I WANT to publish shows & artworks from a simple CMS,

SO THAT a new show goes live without engineering help.

Content first, public READ *piloted early*, then CRUD and the *lead layer*.

TUE Kick-off
Project understanding & scope sign-off with the gallery.

- Brief confirmed
- Backlog seeded

SPRINT 01 Epic 0
Scaffold the foundations — including the events & leads data model.

- Django + DRF + Postgres
- React PWA shell
- Data model · wireframes

SPRINT 02 Epics 1–2
The validated core — and the first real-world test in a gallery.

- Gallery CMS
- Scan → content, 3 formats
- Pilot · events wired early

SPRINT 03 Epics 3–5
Identity, then create / read / update of the wishlist.

- Accounts (JWT)
- Save & revisit works
- Annotate · rename

SPRINT 04 Epics 6–8
Delete, the lead layer & dashboard, PWA hardening, UAT.

- Delete (GDPR)
- **Lead capture & inbox**
- Offline · UAT polish

Two test loops: does the *code* work, and does it work for *prospects*?

TESTING THE CODE

AUTOMATED

- **Unit tests** — pytest for Django / DRF logic; Jest + React Testing Library for components.
- **API & integration** — DRF APIClient covers auth, wishlist CRUD and lead capture.
- **End-to-end** — Playwright walks the critical path: scan → content → save → lead.
- **CI gate** — GitHub Actions runs the suite on every pull request; red build blocks merge.
- **Tenancy** — tests prove one gallery can never read another’s leads or analytics.
- **Performance** — Lighthouse budgets & Web Vitals guard the < 2-second scan-to-content bar.

TESTING WITH USERS

IN THE GALLERY

- **Usability sessions** — think-aloud runs with the prospect and the gallery operator.
- **In-gallery UAT** — from Sprint 2, on real phones, real WiFi and real artwork labels.
- **Task success** — can a first-timer scan and reach content unaided? Time-on-task tracked.
- **Format A/B** — which of text · audio · video actually drives engagement.
- **Lead funnel** — does the opt-in convert, and is the captured context useful to sales?
- **Operator test** — can non-technical gallery staff publish a show with no help?

ACCEPTANCE *A story isn’t “done” until its automated test passes and a real user completes the task it describes.*

Thank you — *your* turn.

I'd value feedback on the pivot to commercial galleries and the lead-capture moat — and approval to begin the Sprint 1 build, READ core first.

FOR YOUR APPROVAL

- i.* Is the pivot sound?
Independent commercial galleries, not museums — real pain, budget, fast decision.
- ii.* Is the moat the right bet?
Lead capture & engagement intelligence in the MVP, not deferred.
- iii.* Is the build order right?
READ core piloted first, then CRUD, then the lead layer.